

✓ DEMOLITION EXPERT

This tough scavenger can reduce a carcass to nothing in minutes. It will attempt to bolt great chunks of meat before other scavengers arrive. Then, if time allows, it dismembers the remains and stashes them nearby. Often, all that is left of a herbivore, such as an antelope, is the green stomach contents.

crest of long hairs along the back lies flat when the animal is relaxed

shorter hind legs add to the front-heavy, skulking appearance

SIZE 1–1.2 m (3¼–4 ft)
HABITAT Open country, savanna grassland, and scrub to semi-desert
DISTRIBUTION North and East Africa, Middle East to East India
DIET Mainly carrion

